

\$170M+ (2025)

Revenue

Oslo

HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

Girish Rishi — Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Cognite.

In role: CEO since 4 April 2022

Today: Leads Cognite's global expansion and the shift of Cognite Data Fusion toward agentic industrial AI for asset-intensive sectors.

A supply-chain and industrial technology operator rather than a data-platform native. He joined Cognite from Blue Yonder (formerly JDA Software), the US supply chain management software company, where he was CEO. Before that he was Senior Vice President at Motorola Solutions and Executive Vice President at Tyco International, with earlier roles as SVP of Matrics and Vice President and General Manager at Symbol Technologies — a career spent close to physical operations, logistics and industrial hardware.

Career: Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Cognite; Chief Executive Officer, Blue Yonder (formerly JDA Software); Executive Vice President, Tyco International; Senior Vice President, Motorola Solutions

Education: MA International Public Policy, Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies

The company: The clearest signal of where this market is heading: an independent industrial-AI platform just sold to a strategic incumbent (Schneider Electric) for 18x revenue, consolidating into AVEVA.

What they sell: Cognite Data Fusion (unified industrial data model + knowledge graph) and Atlas AI (generative/agentic AI for industrial workflows), covering plant operations, asset management and engineering.

02 Where The Company Sits

Closest comparable to Sand on the digital-twin/industrial-data angle specifically. Its \$3.1B exit is the reference point for what a well-executed independent player in this space can be worth.

03 Talking Points

- Supply chain and industrial hardware background — he understands physical operations, which is unusual for a data-platform CEO.
- Aker ASA's majority ownership means Cognite's roadmap answers to an industrial owner; worth understanding what that implies for a PE-owned customer.
- Cognite is small (roughly 367 people). Scale and support coverage are fair questions for a multi-asset deployment.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- About to lose independence entirely — folding into AVEVA under Schneider Electric, with integration risk for customers and staff
- Glassdoor sample size is thin (169 reviews) for a company this size, limiting confidence in the 3.2 rating
- Post-acquisition roadmap and brand continuity are open questions as of the deal announcement

04 GIP Context

GIP: No connection found. Cognite's investor base (Aker ASA, TCV, Accel, Saudi Aramco) has no disclosed GIP tie, and no GIP portfolio company appears among its named customers (Aker BP and others).

BlackRock: No direct stake in Cognite today. Indirect exposure is coming: once Schneider Electric's ~\$3.1B acquisition of Cognite closes, Cognite becomes part of a company where BlackRock is the largest shareholder (7.93% of Schneider Electric, per...)

Others at Cognite: John Markus Lervik (Co-Founder & Chief Strategy Officer); Geir Engdahl (Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer, AI)

www.cognite.com · [CEO appointment announcement](#) · [Businesswire release](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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